Unit 11: Those Winter Sundays (Poem)

Board-style MCQs with answer key at the end

MCQs — Unit 11: Those Winter Sundays (Poem)

Total: 61 MCQs. Answer key is given at the end.

1. The poet of 'Those Winter Sundays' is:

- a) William Blake
- b) Robert Hayden
- c) Emily Dickinson
- d) Langston Hughes

2. Robert Hayden was an:

- a) English poet
- b) American poet
- c) French poet
- d) Irish poet

3. Hayden became the first African American:

- a) President
- b) Consultant in Poetry to the Library of Congress
- c) Nobel laureate
- d) painter

4. The poem has:

- a) 2 stanzas
- b) 3 stanzas
- c) 4 stanzas
- d) 5 stanzas

5. The father got up early on:

- a) weekdays only
- b) Sundays too
- c) holidays only
- d) never

6. The father dressed in the:

- a) warm sun
- b) blueblack cold
- c) rain

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• d) wind

7. The father's hands were:

• a) soft

• b) cracked and aching

• c) clean

• d) strong

8. The father made the banked fires:

• a) go out

• b) blaze

• c) smoke

• d) sleep

9. 'No one ever thanked him' shows the father's sacrifices were:

• a) praised

• b) unacknowledged

• c) rewarded

• d) forgotten by the poet

10. The speaker heard the cold:

• a) singing

• b) splintering, breaking

• c) laughing

• d) whispering

11. When the rooms were warm, the father:

• a) slept

• b) called the speaker

• c) left

• d) ate

12. The speaker feared:

• a) the cold

• b) the chronic angers of that house

• c) the dark

• d) school

13. The speaker spoke to his father:

• a) lovingly

• b) indifferently

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- c) angrily
- d) happily

14. The father had:
- a) driven out the cold
- b) bought new shoes
- c) cooked food
- d) told stories

15. The father polished the speaker's:
- a) books
- b) good shoes
- c) room
- d) bicycle

16. The speaker repeats:
- a) 'What did I know'
- b) 'I love you'
- c) 'Thank you'
- d) 'Good morning'

17. 'Love's austere and lonely offices' means love shown through:
- a) words
- b) plain, lonely duties
- c) gifts
- d) songs

18. The central theme of the poem is:
- a) war
- b) unspoken parental love
- c) friendship
- d) nature

19. The poem is written in:
- a) rhyming couplets
- b) free verse
- c) sonnet form
- d) ballad form

20. Winter in the poem symbolises:
- a) joy

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- b) emotional distance
- c) harvest
- d) festivals

21. The fire in the poem symbolises:

- a) danger
- b) the father's love and warmth
- c) anger
- d) destruction

22. The speaker's viewpoint changes from:

- a) love to hate
- b) childhood indifference to adult regret
- c) joy to sorrow
- d) fear to anger

23. The poet's attitude towards his younger self is:

- a) proud
- b) critical but regretful
- c) indifferent
- d) angry

24. 'Blueblack cold' suggests:

- a) a warm morning
- b) darkness just before dawn
- c) a blue sky
- d) black shoes

25. 'Chronic angers' means:

- a) a single quarrel
- b) a long-lasting tense atmosphere
- c) a loud noise
- d) a cold wind

26. 'Austere' means:

- a) decorated
- b) simple and plain
- c) rich
- d) soft

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27. 'Blaze' means:

- a) to burn brightly
- b) to sleep
- c) to freeze
- d) to rain

28. 'Chronic' means:

- a) brief
- b) lasting a long time
- c) new
- d) easy

29. 'Cracked' means:

- a) whole
- b) damaged with lines in the surface
- c) clean
- d) new

30. 'Lonely' (in 'lonely offices') means:

- a) crowded
- b) where few people come
- c) happy
- d) busy

31. 'Office' (in 'lonely offices') means:

- a) a building
- b) a duty or service
- c) a job title
- d) a room

32. 'Splinter' means:

- a) to break into small sharp pieces
- b) to join
- c) to shine
- d) to melt

33. 'Indifferently' means:

- a) lovingly
- b) without interest or sympathy
- c) angrily

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• d) happily

34. 'Banked' (fires) means:

• a) extinguished

• b) covered with ash to burn slowly

• c) lit high

• d) removed

35. The synonym of 'austere' is:

• a) decorated

• b) plain

• c) rich

• d) soft

36. The synonym of 'chronic' is:

• a) brief

• b) long-term

• c) new

• d) minor

37. The antonym of 'austere' is:

• a) plain

• b) decorated

• c) simple

• d) stern

38. 'The cold splintering, breaking' is an example of:

• a) simile

• b) personification

• c) metaphor

• d) oxymoron

39. 'Weekday weather' shows:

• a) alliteration

• b) personification

• c) symbolism

• d) euphemism

40. 'Love's austere and lonely offices' is a:

• a) simile

• b) metaphor

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- c) oxymoron
- d) alliteration

41. The repetition of 'What did I know' emphasises:

- a) joy
- b) regret
- c) anger
- d) pride

42. The contrast in the poem is between:

- a) warmth and cold
- b) day and night
- c) rich and poor
- d) old and young

43. The father's love is shown through:

- a) words
- b) actions
- c) gifts
- d) letters

44. The speaker's response to the father in childhood was:

- a) gratitude
- b) indifference
- c) love
- d) respect

45. The poem's tone shifts from:

- a) neutral to reflective and regretful
- b) angry to happy
- c) sad to angry
- d) joyful to sad

46. The title uses the plural 'Sundays' to show the sacrifice was:

- a) a single event
- b) repeated every week
- c) imaginary
- d) forgotten

47. 'Polished my good shoes' shows the father's love was:

- a) spoken

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- b) shown through duty
- c) expensive
- d) hidden

48. A full stop is used to:

- a) ask a question
- b) end a statement
- c) show surprise
- d) join clauses

49. A comma is used to:

- a) end a sentence
- b) separate items in a list
- c) ask a question
- d) show possession

50. An exclamation mark is used to:

- a) end a statement
- b) express strong emotion
- c) separate clauses
- d) show possession

51. A semicolon is used to:

- a) join two closely related independent clauses
- b) end a question
- c) list items
- d) show surprise

52. An apostrophe shows:

- a) a question
- b) possession or contraction
- c) a pause
- d) emphasis

53. Quotation marks enclose:

- a) titles only
- b) direct speech or titles
- c) questions
- d) lists

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54. Choose the correct punctuation: 'We had a wonderful vacation in Skardu ___ it was a memorable experience.'

- a) ,
- b) ;
- c) .
- d) !

55. Choose the correct punctuation: 'Some students prefer studying alone ___ others enjoy group discussions.'

- a) ;
- b) , but
- c) .
- d) !

56. Choose the correct punctuation: 'What time will you arrive at the airport tonight ___'

- a) .
- b) !
- c) ?
- d) ,

57. Choose the correct punctuation: 'Father had surgery ___ he had been feeling unwell for weeks.'

- a) ,
- b) ;
- c) ?
- d) !

58. Choose the correct punctuation: 'Can you tell me why she was so angry earlier ___'

- a) .
- b) !
- c) ?
- d) ;

59. The poem's free verse creates a style that is:

- a) formal and musical
- b) natural and conversational
- c) rhyming and rhythmic
- d) ancient

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60. The father's 'cracked hands' tell the story of his:

- a) wealth
- b) hard labour and suffering
- c) laziness
- d) education

61. The speaker's final question shows he now:

- a) hates his father
- b) understands his father's love
- c) forgets the past
- d) blames his father

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Answer Key

No.	Correct Answer
1	b) Robert Hayden
2	b) American poet
3	b) Consultant in Poetry to the Library of Congress
4	b) 3 stanzas
5	b) Sundays too
6	b) blueblack cold
7	b) cracked and aching
8	b) blaze
9	b) unacknowledged
10	b) splintering, breaking
11	b) called the speaker
12	b) the chronic angers of that house
13	b) indifferently
14	a) driven out the cold
15	b) good shoes
16	a) 'What did I know'
17	b) plain, lonely duties
18	b) unspoken parental love
19	b) free verse
20	b) emotional distance
21	b) the father's love and warmth
22	b) childhood indifference to adult regret
23	b) critical but regretful
24	b) darkness just before dawn
25	b) a long-lasting tense atmosphere
26	b) simple and plain
27	a) to burn brightly
28	b) lasting a long time
29	b) damaged with lines in the surface
30	b) where few people come

No.	Correct Answer
31	b) a duty or service
32	a) to break into small sharp pieces
33	b) without interest or sympathy
34	b) covered with ash to burn slowly
35	b) plain
36	b) long-term
37	b) decorated
38	b) personification
39	a) alliteration
40	b) metaphor
41	b) regret
42	a) warmth and cold
43	b) actions
44	b) indifference
45	a) neutral to reflective and regretful
46	b) repeated every week
47	b) shown through duty
48	b) end a statement
49	b) separate items in a list
50	b) express strong emotion
51	a) join two closely related independent clauses
52	b) possession or contraction
53	b) direct speech or titles
54	b) ;
55	b) , but
56	c) ?
57	b) ;
58	c) ?
59	b) natural and conversational
60	b) hard labour and suffering
61	b) understands his father's love